

founder of Digital Bridges, identifies an essential characteristic of wireless gaming:

“Your cell phone offers possibilities which no other technology can match. Imagine sitting in a boardroom or classroom, when your phone bleeps and delivers a message telling you, your ship is under attack. You know that you’re going to stand up and say ‘Excuse me. I have to take this...’

Digital bridges has built its Start Trek games in a persistent universe which means that the game is always on as indeed is your wireless Internet connection with packet data elements like GPRS. Beam down workplace productivity Scotty!

The action adventure format gets a wireless work out by Jamdat, a Californian mobile entertainment technology company.

The success of Gladiator reminds us that games can succeed on relatively simple platforms partly because people have time (particularly when commuting) that is ideal for on-line entertainment. Use of commute time partly explains the success of games in Japan.

For the mobile game industry to flourish, the developer community will need to be nurtured. Carriers will seek open platforms that encourage competition and games creativity, whilst recognising unique mobile network characteristics. The recently announced cooperation between Ericsson, Motorola and Siemens recognises the challenge.

Ericsson, Motorola, Inc. and Siemens Information and Communication Mobile, recently announced plans to develop an industry initiative to define a universal mobile games platform, using existing and emerging standards.

“Our aim is to promote an open approach to the mobile games market by supporting current—and future—standards and by col-